

Alper Sukru Gencer

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Education

New York University, New York, NY

2021-Present: Ph.D., Political Science (ABD Status),

- Fields: Comparative Politics, Quantitative Methods.
- Cumulative GPA: 3.89/4.00.
- Dissertation Committee: Prof. Cyrus Samii (Chair), Prof. Gwyneth McClendon, Prof. Michael Gilligan

Washington University in St. Louis, Saint Louis, MO

2019-2021: M.A., Political Science,

- Fields: Comparative Politics, Quantitative Methods, Formal Theory.
- Cumulative GPA: 3.96/4.00.

Koc University, Istanbul, TURKEY

2017 - 2019: M.A., Political Science and International Relations,

- Magna Cum Laude: Top 5% of the Graduate School,
- Cumulative GPA: 4.00/4.00.

Koc University, Istanbul, TURKEY

2013 - 2017: B.A., Economics,

2011 - 2017: B.A., Political Science,

- Magna Cum Laude: Top 1% of Economics & Political Science,
- Minor in History
- Cumulative GPA: 3.96/4.00.

Bocconi University, Milan, ITALY

2014 - 2015: Erasmus Study Abroad Program in Economics.

Mumtaz Turhan Social Sciences High School, Istanbul, TURKEY

2006 - 2011: High School

- Ranked at the top 5 percent in the 2006 academic cohort

Master's Dissertation

Title: *"Politics of Social Assistance Provision: Contentious Politics and Child Support Grant Provision in South Africa"*

Thesis Defense Date: May 29, 2019

Thesis No: 570863

Thesis Co-Advisors: Prof. Belgin San Akca, Prof. Erdem Yoruk

Thesis Committee Members: Prof. Ziya Onis, Prof. Burak Gürel,
Prof. Murat Koyuncu

Publications in Peer-Reviewed Journals

Yörük, E. & Genç, A.Ş. (2022, September). “The dynamics of welfare state regime development in the global south: Structures, institutions, and political agency.” *Journal of Comparative Policy Analysis*. doi: [10.1080/13876988.2021.2004541](https://doi.org/10.1080/13876988.2021.2004541).

Yörük, E. & Genç, A.Ş. (2020, August). “The politics of social assistance in South Africa: How protests and electoral politics shape the Child Support Grant.” *Governance*. doi: [10.1111/gove.12464](https://doi.org/10.1111/gove.12464).

Öniş, Z. & Genç, A.Ş. (2018, February). “Democratic BRICS as role models in a shifting global order: Inherent dilemmas and the challenges ahead.” *Third World Quarterly*, 39(3). doi: [10.1080/01436597.2018.1438185](https://doi.org/10.1080/01436597.2018.1438185).

Published Reports

Genç, A.Ş. et al. (2018, October). “From information to perception: The journey of the Syrian “ghost” children in Istanbul.” *IstanPol*. Access: [Link](#).

Genç, A.Ş. et al. (2017, July). “From information A study on the perception of asylum-seekers, migrants and refugees in Turkey.” *PS Europe*. Access: [Link](#).

Published Dataset

Yörük E. et al. (2019). “Global Welfare Dataset, Version 2019.” *EMW Project*. Access: [Link](#)

Papers Under Review

Genç, A.Ş. “Rethinking ‘Them’: Challenging Out-Group Stereotypes in Backsliding Democracies.” Under review.

Genç, A.Ş. “When Do Electoral Power Grabs Increase Support for Election Monitoring? Evidence from a Survey Experiment in Turkey.” Under review.

Work in Progress

Genç, A.Ş. “Unbundling Autocratic Capture.” Dissertation project.

Genç, A.Ş., Samii, C. “Optimal Allocation of Compliance Incentives.”

Genç, A.Ş. “Mapping Stereotype-Prone Issues in Polarized Democracies.”

Genç, A.Ş. “What Does Disaster Risk Buy? Political Allocation and the Composition of Mitigation Investment.”

Genç, A.Ş. “When Destruction Does Not Produce Accountability: Disaster Exposure and Incumbent Resilience.”

Genç, A.Ş., Civitarese, C. “Monitoring, Cognitive Load, and Strategic

Omission in Political Communication.”

Geçer, A.Ş., Tafoya, G.R., Yörük, E., & Yoltar, C.. “Carrots and Sticks: Social Assistance as a Containment Strategy in Brazil.”

Conference Presentations

2026: Behavioral Models of Politics
“Unbundling Autocratic Capture”

2026: NYU Rebecca Morton Experimental Conference
“Optimal Allocation of Compliance Incentives”

2025: Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference
“Rethinking ‘Them’: Challenging Out-Group Stereotypes in Backsliding Democracies”

2025: NYU Data Science Frontiers: Society and Politics
“Optimal Allocation of Compliance Incentives”

2024: Rethinking ‘Them’
“Challenging Out-Group Stereotypes in Backsliding Democracies”

Honors and Scholarships

2021 - Present: New York University, Henry M. MacCracken Program Fellowship, New York, NY
- 100%, merit-based scholarship for graduate school tuition and living expenses awarded upon acceptance

2025 - 2026: APSA Dissertation Improvement Grant, Washington, DC
- American Political Science Association; \$13,343 for “Unbundling Autocratic Capture”

2025 - 2026: Identities & Ideologies Project (NYU) Research Grant, New York, NY
- \$3,000 for “Measuring Stereotype-Prone Beliefs: Validation of a Representativeness-Based Algorithm”

2022, 2023, 2025: New York University George Downs Prize, New York, NY
- Competitive departmental award supporting dissertation research in political science
\$1,500 (2022), \$2,500 (2023), \$2,000 (2025)

2019 - 2021: Washington University in St. Louis, Graduate School Scholarship, Saint Louis, MO
- 100%, merit-based scholarship for graduate school tuition and living expenses awarded upon acceptance

2017 - 2019: Tübitak Graduate Scholarship, Ankara, TURKEY
- 2210A - National Scholarship Program for MSc Students by the Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey
- Awarded upon the acceptance to the graduate studies with extraordinary undergraduate records

2017 - 2019: Koç University High Success Scholarship for Graduate Studies, Istanbul, TURKEY
- 100%, merit-based scholarship awarded upon acceptance to the university, for students with graduate studies applicants with extraordinary background
- Covering the graduate studies tuition fee, housing, and miscellaneous benefits for 2 years

2017: Koç University Magna Cum Laude: The Second Ranking Student Award, Istanbul, TURKEY
- Obtained 2nd highest academic record in the Department of Political Science and International Relations among the 2016 – 2017 graduates,

2014 - 2015: Erasmus Exchange Scholarship, Bocconi University, ITALY
- Merit-based scholarship awarded upon acceptance to the Erasmus Program, covering one semester stipend

2013 - 2016: Turkish Education Foundation (TEV) Outstanding Success Scholarship, Istanbul, TURKEY
- Granted by the TEV with the aim of supporting the leaders of the future, highly competitive scholarship awarded to 50 students a year nationwide

2011 - 2017: Koç University High Honor Scholarship for Undergraduate Studies, Istanbul, TURKEY
- 100%, merit-based scholarship awarded upon acceptance to the university, for students who ranked in the top 1000 places at the Nationwide University Entrance Examinations
- Covering the tuition fee, accommodation, stipend for living expenses, and miscellaneous benefits for 6 years.

Employment

September 2023 - Present: Recitation Leader: New York University
New York, NY
- International Relations (Undergraduate, Department of Politics)
- Comparative Politics (Undergraduate, Department of Politics)
- Led weekly discussion sections, graded assignments, and held office hours

September 2017 - August 2019: Koç University, Istanbul, TURKEY
Full-time Researcher and Team Member
- Worked in a European Research Council project, “Emerging Welfare,” under the supervision of Prof. Erdem Yörük
- Wrote an article with Prof. Erdem Yörük, analyzing the role of protests and electoral politics on the social assistance provision based on large-N quantitative analysis and field work
- Conducted interviews with South African state officials, academics and civil

society members

- Responsible for collecting data on welfare, social policy, political and economic indicators
- Responsible for coordination among other data collectors
- Worked on a number of manuscripts investigating the political causes of the social assistance expansion

Research Experience

September 2023 - May 2025: New York University, New York, NY

Research Assistant

- Working in a research project, “xmachine,” under the supervision of Prof. Cyrus Samii and Prof. Michael Gechter
- Manage and analyze experimental and survey data across multiple countries
- Use R, Git, and advanced statistical methods for causal inference and visualization
- Maintain reproducible workflows and assist with manuscript preparation

September 2019 - August 2022: Koç University, Istanbul, TURKEY

Part-time Researcher

- Worked in a European Research Council project, “Emerging Welfare,” under the supervision of Prof. Erdem Yörük
- Worked on a number of manuscripts investigating the political causes of the social assistance expansion

February 2018 - January 2019: Institute of Istanbul Political Research (IstanPol), Istanbul, TURKEY

Volunteer Researcher

- Worked on a project on politics of precariat class and income inequality in Turkey
- Wrote a research paper on perceptions of the Syrian Child Refugees in Turkey

September 2017 - August 2019: Koç University, Istanbul, TURKEY

Full-time Researcher and Team Member

- Worked in a European Research Council project, “Emerging Welfare,” under the supervision of Prof. Erdem Yörük

September 2016 - December 2017: Koç University, Istanbul, TURKEY

Research Assistant (RA)

- Worked under the supervision of Prof. Ziya Öniş
- Published an article on the role model capabilities of the democratic BRICS for the global South

September 2016 - December 2017: Political and Social Research Institute of Europe (PS Europe), Istanbul, TURKEY

Volunteer Researcher

- Worked on a project on politics of precariat class and income inequality
- Wrote a research paper on perceptions of Asylum Seekers, Migrants and

Refugees in Turkey

- Participated in “Armenia Turkey Dialogue Project,” which aimed at establishing a dialogue between Turkish and Armenian academics and civil society activists

September 2016 - June 2017: Koç University, Istanbul, TURKEY

Research Assistant (RA)

- Worked under the supervision of Prof. Ziya Öniş
- Making a literature review on political economy of development and democracy in the global South with a specific focus on the developing countries

Research Interests

Democratic Backsliding, Political Accountability, Electoral Manipulation;
Political Behavior, Affective Polarization, Crisis Politics;
Comparative Politics, Authoritarian Politics, Political Economy;
Survey and Field Experiments, Causal Inference, Experimental Design;
Behavioral Measurement, Adaptive Experiments, Formal Theory;
Disaster Politics, Public Investment, Federal Grants;

Languages and Skills

Turkish (native), English (fluent), French (Intermediate), Arabic (Intermediate)
🔧 (advance), L^AT_EX (advance), 🧩 (intermediate), Stata (intermediate), [Github](#)

Certificates

[Human Research CITI Certificate](#)
[Coursera: Natural Language Processing with Classification and Vector Spaces](#)

Methodology Courses

Course Name	Semester	Cred/Aud	Grade
Grad Experimental Economics	Fall 2023	Credit	A-
Grad Causal Inference	Spring 2022	Credit	A
Grad Game Theory	Spring 2022	Credit	A
Grad Quantitative Methods	Fall 2021	Credit	A
Grad Math for Political Science	Fall 2021	Credit	A
Grad Computational Social Sci.	Fall 2020	Credit	A
UGrad Political Data Science	Spring 2020	Credit	A
Grad Quan. Political Methods II	Fall 2020	Credit	A
Grad Computational Social Sci.	Fall 2020	Credit	A
UGrad Political Data Science	Spring 2020	Credit	A
Grad Advance Game Theory II	Spring 2020	Credit	A
Grad Quan. Political Methods I	Spring 2020	Credit	A
Grad Game Theory I	Fall 2019	Credit	A
UGrad Linear Algebra	Summer 2018	Audit	S
UGrad Econometrics: Panel Data	Spring 2018	Credit	A+
Grad Econometrics	Fall 2018	Audit	S
Grad Quan. Methods in Pol. Sci.	Fall 2017	Credit	A
UGrad Econometrics: Introd.	Spring 2017	Credit	A

References

Prof. Gwyneth McClendon
Dept. of Politics
New York University
gm1143@nyu.edu
- Dissertation Advisor -

Prof. Justin Fox
Dept. of Political Science
Washington University in St. Louis
justin.fox@wustl.edu
- 2021 Application Cycle -

Prof. Erdem Yoruk
Dept. of Sociology
Koç University
eryoruk@ku.edu.tr
+90 (212) 338-1142
- 2019-21 Application Cycles -

Prof. Ziya Öniş
Dept. of International Relations
Koç University
zonis@ku.edu.tr
+90 (212) 338-1142
- 2017-2019 Application Cycles -

Prof. Cyrus Samii
Dept. of Politics
New York University
cyrus.samii@nyu.edu
- Dissertation Chair -

Prof. Guillermo Rosas
Dept. of Political Science
Washington University in St. Louis
grosas@wustl.edu
- 2021 Application Cycle -

Prof. Belgin Şan-Akça
Dept. of International Relations
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bakca@ku.edu.tr
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- 2019 Application Cycle -

Prof. İnsan Tunali
Dept. of Economics
Boğaziçi University
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- 2019 Application Cycle -